

# Leaving is a method, *not a decision.*

The reason leaving the cloud fails is rarely the technology. It is that it is attempted as one decision, executed as one project, and abandoned in the middle with two platforms running and nobody able to say whether it is going well.

This book is 20 Moves. Each is one job with a stated cutover, a stated risk and a rollback that has been thought about. Each can be done on a Tuesday and undone on a Wednesday, and you can stop after any of them and still be somewhere coherent. One of them tells you to keep paying somebody else, and another gives you permission to read three Moves, do the arithmetic and stop.

Every Move covers all three clouds: it names the real service on AWS, Google Cloud and Azure, and the one thing that is different on each.

|                      |                      |
|----------------------|----------------------|
| 20 Moves             | 5 Stages             |
| 18 at zero downtime  | 79 days of work      |
| 3 clouds, every Move | 1 closes the account |

**The whole book is open source.** Every Move, and the software that typesets them into this book, is published under an open licence at [github.com/OneUptime/back-to-metal](https://github.com/OneUptime/back-to-metal). Correct it, extend it, add the services your own estate runs. Infrastructure knowledge this practical should not sit behind a consulting invoice.

# BACK TO METAL

How a startup leaves the cloud, in twenty moves.

BY THE MAKERS OF ONEUPTIME

One Move, one job, one stated cutover.  
A rollback that has been rehearsed.  
And 79 days of work, not four years.

|       |        |                  |                    |
|-------|--------|------------------|--------------------|
| 20    | 5      | 18               | 3                  |
| MOVES | STAGES | AT ZERO DOWNTIME | CLOUDS, EVERY MOVE |

|                                   |   |                                |    |
|-----------------------------------|---|--------------------------------|----|
| What you actually run             | 0 | The first service, end to end  | 0  |
| The number that decides it        | 0 | Buckets, cache and queues      | 0  |
| The three things you keep renting | 0 | Postgres, the one that matters | 15 |
| A cage, not a data centre         | 0 | The front door                 | 0  |
| Racking day                       | 0 | Go-live, and how you abort     | 10 |
| A cluster, in an afternoon        | 0 | Closing the account            | 0  |